PTE Academic: Answer Short Questions

Review bank of common general-knowledge questions, grouped by topic

How to use this bank: Cover the answer column and say your answer aloud within about 3 seconds. Answers are usually one word or a short phrase. Full sentences are not needed, but include an article (*a*, *an*, *the*) where it sounds natural. Where two answers are shown, either is acceptable.

Time and calendar

#	Question	Answer
1	What do we call a period of 10 years?	**A decade**
2	What do we call a period of 100 years?	**A century**
3	What do we call a period of 1,000 years?	**A millennium**
4	Which is the longest: a decade, a century or a millennium?	**A millennium**
5	Name the month that comes between April and June.	**May**
6	Name the month that comes between September and November.	**October**
7	How many months are there in a year?	**Twelve**
8	How many days are there in a leap year?	**366**
9	Some calendars begin the week on Sunday. On which other day does the week commonly start?	**Monday**
10	Winter, spring, summer and autumn are all examples of what?	**Seasons**
11	An assignment is due one month after 15 June. On what date must it be submitted?	**15 July**
12	In which century did large-scale car manufacturing begin?	**The 20th century**
13	What do we call a list of events placed in time order?	**A timeline (or chronology)**
14	What do we call the date by which a piece of work must be finished?	**The deadline (or due date)**

People and jobs

#	Question	Answer
15	What do we call a tradesperson who repairs leaking water pipes?	**A plumber**
16	Who is the official in charge of a football match?	**The referee**
17	What is the job title of someone who designs buildings?	**An architect**
18	Who serves food in a restaurant?	**A waiter (or waitress)**
19	Who is the senior journalist responsible for producing a newspaper or magazine?	**The editor**
20	What do we call a person who watches a sports event?	**A spectator**
21	If the writer of a book is unknown, what word describes the writer?	**Anonymous**
22	Who would you consult to treat a fear of crowded places: a philosopher or a psychologist?	**A psychologist**
23	What do we call the meeting where an employer asks a job applicant about their experience?	**An interview**
24	What do we call the document that lists your qualifications and work experience?	**A resume (or CV / curriculum vitae)**

Health and the body

#	Question	Answer
25	What do we call the joint that connects your hand to your arm?	**The wrist**
26	What organs in your chest do you need in order to breathe?	**The lungs**
27	Which organ does a cardiologist specialise in?	**The heart**
28	What does a dermatologist specialise in?	**The skin (including hair and nails)**
29	What does an ophthalmologist specialise in?	**The eyes**
30	What do we call the picture a doctor takes to see inside your body, for example a broken bone?	**An X-ray**
31	Which hospital department would you go to for an X-ray: radiology or cardiology?	**Radiology**
32	Where would you get a prescription filled after seeing a doctor: a pharmacy or a surgery?	**A pharmacy**
33	If you don't feel like eating, what do we say you have lost?	**Your appetite**
34	If someone feels slightly unwell, they may say they are feeling 'under the ...' what?	**Weather**
35	Besides eating a better diet, what is the other main way people improve their health and fitness?	**Exercise (physical activity)**
36	What do people wear if they cannot see very well?	**Glasses (or contact lenses)**
37	Sight, hearing, touch, taste and smell are known as the five what?	**Senses**
38	Which mineral helps red blood cells carry oxygen around the body?	**Iron**

Science and nature

#	Question	Answer
39	What do we call it when the Moon completely blocks the light of the Sun?	**A (total) solar eclipse**
40	What is the study of stars and planets called?	**Astronomy**
41	What is the study of living things called?	**Biology**
42	What is the source of solar energy?	**The Sun**
43	What do we call a large natural body that orbits the Sun, such as Earth or Mars?	**A planet**
44	Which instrument would you use to examine very small objects or life forms?	**A microscope**
45	Animals such as humans that usually give birth to live young are called mammals or reptiles?	**Mammals**
46	In the animal kingdom, is camouflage used to attract a mate, find food or hide?	**To hide**
47	What happens to ice when it is left at room temperature?	**It melts into water**
48	Which sweet food is produced by bees?	**Honey**
49	What type of food is an apple?	**A fruit**
50	What is the collective term for cows and bulls, especially on a farm?	**Cattle**
51	What do we call the place where a river begins?	**Its source**
52	Which mineral makes seawater different from fresh water?	**Salt**
53	If something such as fabric or medicine is artificially made, what do we say it is?	**Synthetic**
54	Which of these was explored last: the Himalayas, the Moon or Australia?	**The Moon**

Geography and travel

#	Question	Answer
55	Which compass point is directly opposite East?	**West**
56	Is an urban area found in a city or in the countryside?	**In a city**
57	A famous canal links the Mediterranean Sea with the Indian Ocean (via the Red Sea). Is it the Corinth or the Suez Canal?	**The Suez Canal**
58	Which country is in the Southern Hemisphere: Canada or Australia?	**Australia**
59	The large island just off the coast of mainland Europe is home to which country?	**The United Kingdom**
60	Name a country in North America.	**Canada, the United States or Mexico**
61	Which would cover the largest area: a town, a city or a village?	**A city**
62	What is the quickest way to travel from Hong Kong to Paris?	**By plane**
63	What document do most people carry when travelling from one country to another?	**A passport**
64	What is the most important document you must show to hire a car?	**A driver's licence**
65	Which section of a train timetable tells you what time the train leaves?	**Departures**
66	How do most people travel to work in big cities like Hong Kong, Tokyo and New York?	**By public transport**
67	Which desk do you go to when you first arrive at a hotel?	**Reception (the front desk)**
68	To report the population of a major world city, would you use hundreds, millions or billions?	**Millions**
69	Would you use kilometres or kilograms to measure the distance between two cities?	**Kilometres**
70	Would you measure a bottle of water in litres or kilograms?	**Litres**
71	What unit would you use to weigh a butterfly?	**Grams (or milligrams)**

Home, shopping and daily life

#	Question	Answer
72	Where do you pay for your shopping in a supermarket?	**At the checkout (or till)**
73	What do we call a piece of paper that proves you bought an item?	**A receipt**
74	Apart from cash, what is the other main way to pay in a shop?	**By card (credit or debit)**
75	If something is not expensive, what do we say it is?	**Cheap (or inexpensive)**
76	Where would you buy flour: a bakery, a florist or a supermarket?	**A supermarket**
77	Which would probably have the widest range of products: a supermarket, a cafe or a bookshop?	**A supermarket**
78	What do you call an apartment below ground level: a basement apartment or a penthouse?	**A basement apartment**
79	What do we call the money you pay a landlord to live in their house or apartment?	**Rent**
80	Where would you keep meat you want to store frozen at home?	**In the freezer**
81	In which room of a home would someone usually wash their clothes?	**The laundry**
82	Which of these is found in most homes around the world: a computer, a bed or a TV?	**A bed**
83	What do we call the first meal of the day?	**Breakfast**
84	What can you add to a drink to cool it down on a hot day?	**Ice (ice cubes)**
85	What is the last step when baking a cake?	**Baking it in the oven**
86	What would you use to climb up onto the roof of a house?	**A ladder**
87	What do we call a list of steps that tells you how to put something together?	**Instructions**
88	What do we call a book that lists words alphabetically with their meanings?	**A dictionary**
89	Where can people go to borrow books?	**A library**
90	Which of these would probably be found in an office: a printer, a blanket or a nail brush?	**A printer**
91	What feature do pianos and computers have in common?	**A keyboard (keys)**
92	What is the main difference between a wristwatch and a clock?	**Their size**

Sport and leisure

#	Question	Answer
93	What do we call the last game in a competition, which decides the champion?	**The final**
94	Where would you go to work out on a treadmill?	**A gym**
95	Which equipment would you use to dive under the sea: an aqualung or an aquaplane?	**An aqualung**
96	What protects a motorbike rider's head from injury?	**A helmet**
97	Which emergency service is called when someone is in trouble at sea: an ambulance or the coastguard?	**The coastguard**
98	In which season are people least likely to go skiing?	**Summer**
99	If you want to avoid the hottest part of the day, should you jog at noon or in the early morning?	**In the early morning**
100	Do more men or women play professional football?	**More men**
101	What do we call a company that gives money to an event in exchange for advertising?	**A sponsor**

Arts, media and technology

#	Question	Answer
102	What do we call a painting of a person's head and face?	**A portrait**
103	What is the general term for paintings of the countryside or natural views?	**Landscape**
104	Where would you go to see an exhibition of sculpture?	**An art gallery (or museum)**
105	Where would you see dinosaur exhibits?	**In a museum**
106	Which section of a newspaper gives the editor's opinion?	**The editorial**
107	What do we call copying a program or file from a website onto your computer?	**Downloading**
108	What is a harmful program that spreads from computer to computer?	**A (computer) virus**
109	Which is the fastest way to send a message to your professor: a letter or an email?	**An email**
110	In business and advertising, what does PR stand for?	**Public relations**

Study and academic life

#	Question	Answer
111	What do we call the alphabetical list at the back of a book that shows where to find information?	**The index**
112	What do we call the very long essay a student writes for a doctoral degree?	**A thesis (or dissertation)**
113	At which ceremony do students receive their degree or diploma?	**Graduation**
114	Most university courses assess students orally or through what?	**Written assignments (or exams)**
115	If a telescope is used for distant objects, which instrument is used for tiny objects?	**A microscope**
116	Which branch of science deals with the classification of living things, including humans?	**Biology**

Society, government and economics

#	Question	Answer
117	What do we call a system of government where people vote for their representatives?	**Democracy**
118	What word describes an economy based mainly on farming?	**Agricultural**
119	Which sector of the economy deals with farming?	**Agriculture**
120	What does a business want to make instead of a loss?	**A profit**
121	What do we call a period when a country's economy declines significantly?	**A recession**
122	Which punishment is less severe: imprisonment or community service?	**Community service**
123	What crime has someone committed if they steal from a shop: shopfitting or shoplifting?	**Shoplifting**
124	What does a king or queen wear on their head at official ceremonies?	**A crown**
125	How many sides are involved in a bilateral agreement?	**Two**
126	How many sides does a hexagon have?	**Six**
127	In geometry, what is a shape with three sides called?	**A triangle**
128	A factory releases harmful gases. Which safety measure matters most: good ventilation or suitable footwear?	**Good ventilation**
129	If you are feeling 'fed up', is that a positive or negative feeling?	**Negative**

129 questions. Prepared by NextGen Nurses for exam practice.